

ZETDC EASTERN REGION		
REVISION: 0	DOCUMENT TYPE: PROCEDURE TITLE: ACCIDENT REPORTING AND INVESTIGATION PROCEDURE	DOCUMENT NO: SHE 01
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1. PURPOSE

To establish a procedure for the uniform internal investigation of all accidents and/or incidents for the purpose of preventing similar accidents or incidents from recurring in the future.

2. SCOPE

This procedure applies to all ZETDC Eastern region operations.

3. RESPONSIBILITIES

3.1 The Regional General Manager is responsible for ensuring that this procedure is implemented, maintained and regularly reviewed in line with the changes in operations, technology, legislation, standards, circumstances and policies

4. DEFINITIONS

- 4.1 GM – General Manager
- 4.2 HRAM – Human Resource and Administration Manager
- 4.3 CRO – Chief Risk Officer
- 4.4 HSO – Health and Safety Officer
- 4.5 EMS -Environmental Management System.
- 4.6 OHS – Occupational Health and Safety
- 4.7 SAZS – Standards Association of Zimbabwe Standard.
- 4.8 ISO – International Organisation for Standardisation.
- 4.9 P - Procedure.

TITLE: ACCIDENT REPORTING AND INVESTIGATION PROCEDURE		DOCUMENT NO: SHE 01
ISSUE DATE: 23/02/16	REVISION: 0	
STATUS: CONTROLLED COPY		

5. ACTIVITY DESCRIPTION

- 5.1 Every person involved in an occupational accident or incident must report the accident/ incident immediately to the supervisor who should report the accident/ incident to the Senior Local Official.
- 5.2 The Senior Local Official shall report the accident to the Management, NSSA and to the Risk Management Department within 24 hours.
- 5.3 The Senior Local Official shall fill in the accident report form (FG2 form), certificate of injury (W.C.I.F 16), W.C.I.F 14, and the accident register where necessary.
- 5.4 If the accident results in a serious injury such that the victim cannot report the accident to his or her supervisor, any other person in witness of the accident should do so on behalf of the victim.
- 5.5 In the event of a fatal accident, stop the process involved only and do not interfere with evidence but leave everything as it is and take photographs where possible.
- 5.6 In a fatal accident the Senior Local Official contacts the Inspector of Factories and the Police, while the Group Stakeholder Relation Manager handles the press and other relevant interested parties.

ESTABLISHING THE FACTS OF THE ACCIDENT OR INCIDENT

- 5.7 All occupational accidents and incidents must be reported to the Management in writing within 24 hours.
- 5.8 All occupational accidents and incidents must be investigated within 3 days of their occurrence in order to capture fresh evidence and to comply with the law (S.I 68 of 1990 and RGN 263 of 1976).

All occupational accident or incident investigations must be systematic aiming to:

- Find out circumstances leading to the accident
- Identify all immediate and underlying causes;
- Find out whether the accident was avoidable;
- Obtain any safety documents that were issued;
- Establish whether safety rules were followed;
- Provide any relevant information;
- Determine the damage or injury caused by the accident;
- Identify corrective measures and
- Give recommendations to prevent recurrence of such accidents;

- 5.9 The investigation panel for all fatalities, lost time injuries, minor, near misses and property damage accidents are chaired by the Maintenance Engineer or Chief Risk Officer in his/her absence.
- 5.10 The investigation panel shall be composed of:
 - a) The chairperson;

TITLE: ACCIDENT REPORTING AND INVESTIGATION PROCEDURE		DOCUMENT NO: SHE 01
ISSUE DATE: 23/02/16	REVISION: 0	
STATUS: CONTROLLED COPY		

- b) One technical person from Engineering Department
- c) Other members can be added as the General Manager/ Engineering Manager sees fit.
- d) The HSO where possible or any other person charged with reporting on safety, health and environmental performance takes minutes of the proceedings which shall be distributed to all Heads of Department, safety committee chairperson and the investigation team members.

- 5.11 The Chairperson decides on the date, time and venue of the investigation to meet the deadline and informs the rest of the investigation team.
- 5.12 The committee invites safety documents and written submissions from witnesses of the accident or incident including a diagram or sketch of the scene of the accident or incident.
- 5.13 The CRO or any other person charged with reporting on safety, health and environmental performance ensures that the investigation occurs on time.
- 5.14 Accident or incident investigations are not disciplinary hearings and as such no representations are necessary.**
- 5.15 The chairperson leads the investigation team in asking the following questions:

What

- Was the accident or incident?
- Was the damage or loss, if there was any?
- Was the injury, if there was any?
- Led to the accident or incident?
- Time did the accident or incident occurs?
- Was the weather like?
- Was the employee or contractor doing in the time preceding the accident?
- Type of equipment or place was involved?
- Needed to be done to prevent the accident?
- Specific precautions were actually taken to prevent the accident?
- Previous similar accidents or incidents have occurred?
- Action had been taken to prevent recurrence?
- Safety rules were not followed?
- Type of training had the worker received for competency in job safety?
- Were the mechanical causes of the accident or incident?
- Were the environmental causes of the accident or incident?
- Were the system causes of the accident or incident?
- Was the immediate cause of the accident?
- Was the underlying cause of the accident?

Who

- ❖ Else was or were involved in the accident or incident?
- ❖ Gave the authority for the worker for what he or she was doing?
- ❖ Saw the accident or incident happening?
- ❖ Could have helped to stop the accident or incident?

TITLE: ACCIDENT REPORTING AND INVESTIGATION PROCEDURE		DOCUMENT NO: SHE 01
ISSUE DATE: 23/02/16	REVISION: 0	
STATUS: CONTROLLED COPY		

- ❖ Was responsible or accountable for the actions that led to the accident?
- ❖ Else has information of events prior to the accident or incident?

When

- ✓ Did the damage become evident?
- ✓ Was the equipment last serviced?
- ✓ Was something observed to be wrong?
- ✓ Was the accident or incident reported to the immediate supervisor?

WHERE

- Did the accident or incident happen?
- Was the witness at the time of the accident or incident?

WHY

- Did the accident occur?
- Did the injury occur, if there was any?
- Was the accident permitted to occur?
- Was the hazard not realized and evaluated on time to prevent the accident?
- Was the injured where he or she was at the time?
- Was everything else that needed to be done to prevent the accident not done?

HOW

- ✓ Accurate is the sketch of the scene of the accident or incident?
- ✓ Did the accident or incident occur?
- ✓ How good was the general lighting?
- ✓ Good was the condition of the equipment?
- ✓ Good was the condition of the general environment?
- ✓ How much is likely to be lost by the company when every cost is considered?
- ✓ Much will the repairs to the equipment cost?
- ✓ Much will the repairs of the third party's equipment cost if there are any?
- ✓ Could the accident or incident have been avoided?
- ✓ Was the response to the accident or incident?
- ✓ Best can the worker's attitude be described at the time of the accident or incident (careful, careless, reckless or malicious)
- ✓ Could the system have prevented the accident or incident?
- ✓ Could the supervisor have prevented the accident or incident?

5.16 Witnesses can also be interviewed.

5.17 Where different witnesses give different accounts of the same accident or incident, the investigating team should look for similarities between the statements and commonality with other evidence with the objective of understanding the accident or incident and not to prove the accuracy of individual statements nor to apportion blame.

TITLE: ACCIDENT REPORTING AND INVESTIGATION PROCEDURE		DOCUMENT NO: SHE 01
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- 5.18 Where necessary an inspection in loco of the equipment and/or the scene of the accident can be carried out to gain more important evidence through observation.
- 5.19 The chairperson and his team, after exhausting the questions in 5.18 and requirements of 5.19, 5.20 and 5.21 respectively, give a precise summary description of the accident or incident, its background, timing, the events leading to it and all pertinent issues relating to the accident or incident with immediate and underlying causes.
- 5.20 The investigating team members agree and put forward date controlled actions or recommendations complete with appointed personnel to action them. The actions or recommendations shall be classified as follows:
- Actions or recommendations to be implemented immediately.
 - Actions or recommendations to be implemented as soon as practical.
 - Actions or recommendations to be implemented in the long term.

6. RECORDS

The following records shall be generated from implementation of this procedure.

Name of record:	Custodian / location:	Retention period:
Accident report form (FG2 Form)	S/CSO/ Network Manager CRO	5yrs
Accident Register	Depot Foreperson	5yrs
Group Personal Accident Register	C.R.O.	5yrs
Accident investigation report	GM/ EM/ Network Manager/ CRO/ S/CSO	5yrs

After the retention period of 5 years all the records shall be archived for a period of 30 years.

7. REFERENCES

- 7.1 OHSAS 18001: 2008 Standard
- 7.2 ISO 14001: 2004 Standard
- 7.3 OHS policy